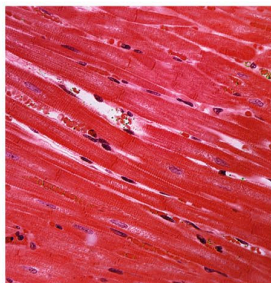


CARDIAC MUSCLE

The walls of the heart are made of a special type of muscle known as cardiac muscle, which is found only in the heart. Unlike other types of muscle, cardiac muscle can contract repeatedly without becoming tired. However, to maintain this constant activity, the muscle requires a continuous, ample supply of oxygenated blood, provided by the coronary arteries.

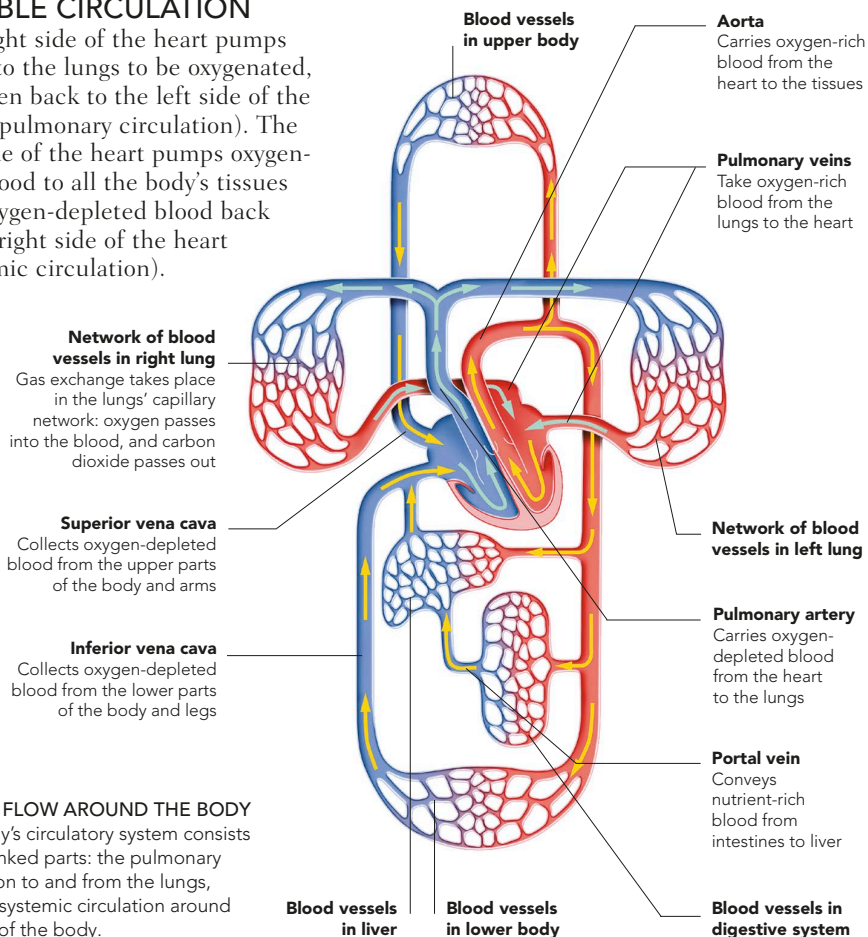


CARDIAC MUSCLE TISSUE

Cardiac muscle is a type of involuntary muscle, with short, branched, striated muscle fibres.

DOUBLE CIRCULATION

The right side of the heart pumps blood to the lungs to be oxygenated, and then back to the left side of the heart (pulmonary circulation). The left side of the heart pumps oxygen-rich blood to all the body's tissues and oxygen-depleted blood back to the right side of the heart (systemic circulation).



BLOOD FLOW AROUND THE BODY

The body's circulatory system consists of two linked parts: the pulmonary circulation to and from the lungs, and the systemic circulation around the rest of the body.